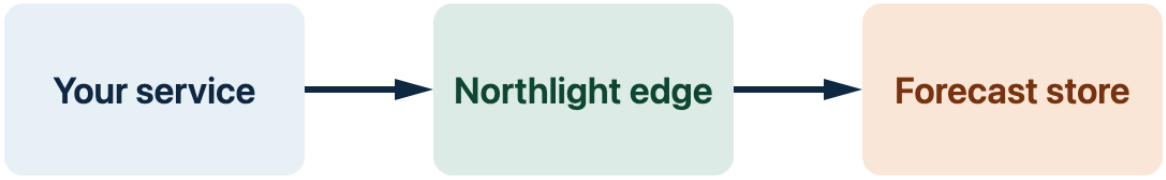
Getting started

Three steps take you from nothing to a first forecast. The whole flow is one HTTPS request with a key in a header; there is no SDK to install.



GET /v1/weather/current?station=… → cached at the edge for 60 seconds → read from the store on a miss

Get a key

Keys are issued per project and scoped to the stations a project may read.

Requirements

Step	Prerequisites	
Register	• A project name • A billing contact • At least one station	• Accepted terms • A callback URL
Rotate	• The current key • Owner role	

> **Keep the key out of the browser**
>
> A key grants every scope its project holds. Call Northlight from your own backend and pass results on; never ship the key in client-side code.

Make a request New

Send the key in the `Authorization` header and ask for a station by its code:

```
curl -H "Authorization: Bearer $NORTHLIGHT_KEY" \
  "https://api.northlight.example/v1/weather/current?station=OSL-01"
```

```
{
  "station": "OSL-01",
  "observedAt": "2026-09-22T06:00:00Z",
  "temperatureC": 11.4,
  "windMs": 3.2,
  "conditions": "overcast"
}
```

Every response carries `observedAt`, the instant the station reported[1]. A missing station returns `404` with a machine-readable `code`, listed under Error codes.

Stay within the limits

Current conditions are cached at the edge for sixty seconds, so polling faster than that returns the same reading and spends your quota. The windows and the headers that report them are in Rate limits; the short version is below.

Windows

As a new integrator you share one rule: a key may make 60 requests per rolling minute to `/v1/weather/current` and 600 per rolling hour across all endpoints. Both counters are reported on every response.

Header	Meaning
`X-Limit-Minute`	Requests left in the current minute window.
`X-Limit-Hour`	Requests left in the current hour window.
`Retry-After`	Seconds to wait, present only on a `429`.

> **Bursts are counted per key**
>
> Two services sharing one key share one window. Give each service its own key so a spike in one cannot starve the other.

Footnotes

1. Always UTC, always with a `Z` suffix. Convert at the edge of your own system, not in the data layer. ↩